

CV and Resume

A **resume** is a one-to-two page document presenting key facts about your professional experience, educational background, and skills. A **resume** is used for job search; **CV** (Curriculum Vitae) is a longer document that details the whole course of your career. CV is used for academic purposes.

A Curriculum Vitae (CV) is a detailed document that outlines an individual's educational background, work experience, skills, achievements, and other professional credentials. Unlike a resume, which is typically brief and tailored for specific jobs, a CV provides an in-depth overview of a person's academic and career history. The term "Curriculum Vitae" is Latin for "course of life."

It is commonly used in academic, education, research, and medical fields.

Characteristics of a Good CV

A well-structured CV should reflect the following characteristics:

a. Clarity and Precision

Information should be presented clearly and concisely.

Avoid unnecessary jargon or lengthy paragraphs.

b. Well-Organized Format

Typically includes sections like Personal Details, Career Objective, Education, Work Experience, Skills, Certifications, and References.

Consistent formatting (fonts, bullet points, spacing).

c. Chronological Order

Lists experiences and education in reverse chronological order (most recent first).

d. Tailored Content

Should be adapted to suit the job role or academic program being applied for.

e. Accuracy and Honesty

All details should be factual and verifiable.

f. Professional Language

Formal tone, without slang or overly casual language.

g. Up-to-Date Information

Includes the most recent qualifications, experiences, and skills.

h. Length

Usually 2–3 pages or more, depending on the level of experience.

Definition of Resume

A Resume is a formal document that summarizes an individual's professional background, including work experience, education, skills, and achievements relevant to a specific job or industry.

The word resume comes from the French term meaning “summary”.

It is typically 1–2 pages long and is used when applying for jobs, internships, or work-related opportunities. A resume is usually tailored for each specific job application to highlight the most relevant qualifications.

Characteristics of a Good Resume

A well-crafted resume should reflect the following characteristics:

a. Concise and Focused

Typically 1 page (for freshers) and up to 2 pages for experienced professionals.
Only includes information relevant to the job being applied for.

b. Tailored Content

Customized to match the job description.
Uses keywords from the job posting.

c. Well-Organized Layout

Clearly divided into sections like Objective, Education, Experience, Skills, etc.
Consistent formatting and professional fonts.

d. Bullet Points for Clarity

Achievements and responsibilities are listed using bullet points for easy reading.

e. Quantifiable Achievements

Highlights accomplishments with facts and figures when possible. Example: “Increased sales by 30% in 6 months.”

f. Professional Language and Tone

Avoids slang, grammatical errors, or overly casual language.

g. Visually Clean Design

Uses white space effectively and avoids clutter.
Professional appearance with minimal graphics.

h. Accurate and Truthful

All information provided must be honest and verifiable.